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Submitter Information

Name: David Soules

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General Comment

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Artificial Intelligence, as currently conceived, is diametrically opposed to human flourishing, economic competitiveness, and national security. The US would be best served by cutting its losses in investment in this wasteful and grotesquely overhyped technology.

AI companies have made extravagant promises—indeed, the same promises, renewed every few months when a new version is released, promising that the new model will succeed where the previous models failed. Training future versions requires exponentially more power and data for inputs—power which is taxing our electrical generation capabilities and data which does not exist, as we are already training current models with at least a quarter of the available Internet and thus cannot provide another order of magnitude increase in data that would be required for linear growth of model capabilities.

Moreover, this training regime requires giving a completely unwarranted exception to copyright law for particular privileged companies—the exact opposite of a fair and competitive market of ideas. As Sam Altman has stated, AI training is not possible without appropriating the intellectual property of copyright holders—behavior that we have justly condemned when it has been contemplated by a strategic adversary.

Despite these very real costs to our resources and legal rights, AI is extremely unlikely to achieve any meaningful progress toward general intelligence. It can produce an impressive simulacrum of coherent language, but it does not engage in meaningful reflection (despite the countless metaphors inappropriately employed by practitioners) and its hallucination problems make it unfit to purpose for most meaningful tasks.

This lack of promise can be seen in the dearth of organizations which have seen significant profitable application of the technology. While we promise businesses the ability (very soon!) to replace human workers with an automaton, what we have received is inaccurate summaries, an inability to cite sources properly, continuous (at times libelous) confabulation, and bots that undermine the interests of their users, making promises contrary to company policy or material reality.

Our country's interests are best served by stopping investment into this field and instead targeting it to field- and problem-specific machine learning methods, which do show considerable effectiveness; or putting these resources towards general research and university education.

Thank you for your attention to this matter.